SSC MTS 2023 question paper with answers

5 September 2023 · Shift 2

32 questions as the Staff Selection Commission (SSC) printed them · answers from the official key · marking: 3 marks a question; no negative marking in Session-I (Numerical and Mathematical Ability, Reasoning), 1 mark deducted for each wrong answer in Session-II (General Awareness, English).

The other 58 of the paper's 90 questions are not reproduced: they need a figure or are printed as an image, or ask about formatting the source does not keep.

Try every question first: the answer key and the explanations follow the questions. Official answer-key notice: https://web.archive.org/web/20231223070914/https://ssc.nic.in/SSCFileServer/PortalManagement/UploadedFiles/Writeup_MTS2023_22122023.pdf

General Awareness 7 questions

Q.3

Which physiographic division of India from the following is formed of alluvial soil?

(A) The Peninsular Plateau
(B) The Himalayan Mountains
(C) The Islands
(D) The Northern Plains

Q.5

Laterite soil develops as a result of which of the following reasons?

(A) Compaction
(B) Leaching
(C) High temperature only
(D) Sedimentation

Q.11

As per the Census of India 2011, which state recorded a negative population growth rate?

(A) Sikkim
(B) Kerala
(C) Arunachal Pradesh
(D) Nagaland

Q.12

In March 2023, Rajasthan became the first state in India to provide right to ___ for its people.

(A) accommodation
(B) education
(C) telecommunication
(D) health

Q.15

Which state has the maximum number of Jute mills (as of 2022)?

(A) Tripura
(B) Uttar Pradesh
(C) Assam
(D) West Bengal

Q.18

Born on _____, Mohandas Karamchand Gandhi whose birthday is celebrated as Gandhi Jayanti, successfully led India’s non-violence movement against the British.

(A) 2 October 1868
(B) 2 October 1870
(C) 2 October 1867
(D) 2 October 1869

Q.23

Which of the following is a white to yellowish solid with a weak aromatic odour purified by the process of sublimation?

(A) Titanyl
(B) Orthovanadate
(C) Anthracene
(D) Dysprosium

English Language and Comprehension 25 questions

Q.1

The following sentence has been split into four segments. Identify the segment that contains a spelling error. Several days later, / he received a written / comeunication from the magistrate / that the case has been dropped.

(A) Several days later,
(B) he received a written
(C) comeunication from the magistrate
(D) that the case has been dropped

Q.2

Select the option that can be used as a one-word substitute for the given group of words. A man whose wife is dead

(A) Widower
(B) Ascetic
(C) Widow
(D) Bachelor

Q.3

Select the most appropriate option that can substitute the underlined segment in the given sentence. “No sooner did he finished” his examination than he left for his cricket training centre.

(A) no sooner did he finish
(B) no sooner than he finished
(C) no sooner than he did finished
(D) no sooner had he finish

Q.4

Parts of the following sentence have been given as options. Select the option that contains an error. They will start their journey after the breakfast.

(A) will start
(B) their journey
(C) They
(D) after the breakfast

Q.5

Select the INCORRECTLY spelt word.

(A) Wholeness
(B) Overwhelming
(C) Legandry
(D) Inclusive

Q.6

Select the most appropriate ANTONYM of the given word. Humane

(A) Proud
(B) Kind
(C) Cruel
(D) Imperfect

Q.7

Select the correctly spelt word.

(A) Prevenseon
(B) Prevention
(C) Previnsion
(D) Prevension

Q.8

Parts of the given sentence have been underlined. One of them contains an error. The underlined parts are given as options with some changes. Select the option that correctly rectifies the error. He “is good” “at playing” “the guitar” “than” his brother.

(A) is better
(B) in playing
(C) guitar
(D) to

Q.9

Select the most appropriate ANTONYM of the word given in brackets to fill in the blank. The company is looking for some _____(idle) workers who can join the organisation immediately.

(A) diligent
(B) coy
(C) callous
(D) sober

Q.10

Select the option that can be used as a one-word substitute for the underlined group of words. He simply continued to “say something in order to convey information” in a calm voice.

(A) dictate
(B) teach
(C) speak
(D) spell

Q.11

Select the most appropriate meaning of the underlined idiom. After years of rivalry, the two families decided to “bury the hatchet.”

(A) To continue an old quarrel
(B) To end a quarrel by never talking to each other
(C) To end a quarrel and become friendly
(D) To start a new quarrel

Q.12

The following sentence has been split into four segments. Identify the segment that contains an error. Did / her friend / went to / school yesterday?

(A) went to
(B) school yesterday
(C) her friend
(D) Did

Q.13

Select the most appropriate option that can substitute the underlined segment in the given sentence. The Delhi administration is seriously worried about “the warning to civic health” posed by the polluted waters of Yamuna.

(A) a peril to civic health
(B) the notice to civic health
(C) the plague to civic health
(D) the threat to civic health

Q.14

The following sentence has been split into four segments. Identify the segment that contains a grammatical error. Mohan is respected / by everyone / because he works / hardly.

(A) by everyone
(B) because he works
(C) hardly
(D) Mohan is respected

Q.15

Select the most appropriate meaning of the given idiom. Day and night

(A) Continuously
(B) Clumsily
(C) Adversely
(D) Diligently

Q.16

Select the most appropriate ANTONYM of the given word. Humility

(A) Shyness
(B) Timidity
(C) Arrogance
(D) Obedience

Q.17

The following sentence has been split into four segments. Identify the segment that contains an error. They had been dancing / for an hour / when our dance teacher / had arrived.

(A) when our dance teacher
(B) They had been dancing
(C) for an hour
(D) had arrived

Q.18

Select the most appropriate idiom to fill in the blank. Jane, please don't tell me fairy tales; I just want to know the real matter _____.

(A) in the cold
(B) in a fortnight
(C) in the long run
(D) in a nutshell

Q.19

Select the most appropriate meaning of the underlined idiom. The shopkeeper was "sly as a fox" and tried to sell off the old stock.

(A) smart and clever
(B) slow
(C) suspicious
(D) in confusion or disagreement

Q.20

Select the most appropriate option to fill in the blank. Bhanu, the security guard, asks everyone entering my building to show their _____ card.

(A) identity
(B) place
(C) self
(D) name

Q.21

In the following passage, some words have been deleted. Read the passage carefully and select the most appropriate option to fill in each blank. Effective communication is about more than just exchanging information. It's about understanding the emotion and intentions (1)_____ the information. As well as being able to clearly convey a message, you need to also (2)____ in a way that gains the full meaning of what's being said and makes the other person feel heard and understood. For many of us, communicating more clearly and effectively requires learning some (3)_____ skills. Whether you're trying to improve communication with your spouse, kids, boss, or coworkers, learning these skills can (4)_____ your connections to others, build greater trust and respect, and (5)_____ teamwork, problem solving, and your overall social and emotional health.

Select the most appropriate option to fill in blank number 1.

(A) behind
(B) in front of
(C) above
(D) below

Q.22

In the following passage, some words have been deleted. Read the passage carefully and select the most appropriate option to fill in each blank. Effective communication is about more than just exchanging information. It's about understanding the emotion and intentions (1)_____ the information. As well as being able to clearly convey a message, you need to also (2)____ in a way that gains the full meaning of what's being said and makes the other person feel heard and understood. For many of us, communicating more clearly and effectively requires learning some (3)_____ skills. Whether you're trying to improve communication with your spouse, kids, boss, or coworkers, learning these skills can (4)_____ your connections to others, build greater trust and respect, and (5)_____ teamwork, problem solving, and your overall social and emotional health.

Select the most appropriate option to fill in blank number 2.

(A) think
(B) talk
(C) listen
(D) speak

Q.23

In the following passage, some words have been deleted. Read the passage carefully and select the most appropriate option to fill in each blank. Effective communication is about more than just exchanging information. It's about understanding the emotion and intentions (1)_____ the information. As well as being able to clearly convey a message, you need to also (2)____ in a way that gains the full meaning of what's being said and makes the other person feel heard and understood. For many of us, communicating more clearly and effectively requires learning some (3)_____ skills. Whether you're trying to improve communication with your spouse, kids, boss, or coworkers, learning these skills can (4)_____ your connections to others, build greater trust and respect, and (5)_____ teamwork, problem solving, and your overall social and emotional health.

Select the most appropriate option to fill in blank number 3.

(A) boring
(B) trivial
(C) wasteful
(D) important

Q.24

In the following passage, some words have been deleted. Read the passage carefully and select the most appropriate option to fill in each blank. Effective communication is about more than just exchanging information. It's about understanding the emotion and intentions (1)_____ the information. As well as being able to clearly convey a message, you need to also (2)____ in a way that gains the full meaning of what's being said and makes the other person feel heard and understood. For many of us, communicating more clearly and effectively requires learning some (3)_____ skills. Whether you're trying to improve communication with your spouse, kids, boss, or coworkers, learning these skills can (4)_____ your connections to others, build greater trust and respect, and (5)_____ teamwork, problem solving, and your overall social and emotional health.

Select the most appropriate option to fill in blank number 4.

(A) hamper
(B) trivialise
(C) disturb
(D) deepen

Q.25

In the following passage, some words have been deleted. Read the passage carefully and select the most appropriate option to fill in each blank. Effective communication is about more than just exchanging information. It's about understanding the emotion and intentions (1)_____ the information. As well as being able to clearly convey a message, you need to also (2)____ in a way that gains the full meaning of what's being said and makes the other person feel heard and understood. For many of us, communicating more clearly and effectively requires learning some (3)_____ skills. Whether you're trying to improve communication with your spouse, kids, boss, or coworkers, learning these skills can (4)_____ your connections to others, build greater trust and respect, and (5)_____ teamwork, problem solving, and your overall social and emotional health.

Select the most appropriate option to fill in blank number 5.

(A) hamper
(B) hasten
(C) improve
(D) disturb

Answer key

General Awareness

Q.3 **(D)**	Q.5 **(B)**	Q.11 **(D)**	Q.12 **(D)**	Q.15 **(D)**	Q.18 **(D)**
Q.23 **(C)**					

English Language and Comprehension

Q.1 **(C)**	Q.2 **(A)**	Q.3 **(A)**	Q.4 **(D)**	Q.5 **(C)**	Q.6 **(C)**
Q.7 **(B)**	Q.8 **(A)**	Q.9 **(A)**	Q.10 **(C)**	Q.11 **(C)**	Q.12 **(A)**
Q.13 **(D)**	Q.14 **(C)**	Q.15 **(A)**	Q.16 **(C)**	Q.17 **(D)**	Q.18 **(D)**
Q.19 **(A)**	Q.20 **(A)**	Q.21 **(A)**	Q.22 **(C)**	Q.23 **(D)**	Q.24 **(D)**
Q.25 **(C)**					

Explanations

General Awareness

Q.3 · Answer (D) The Northern Plains

The Northern Plains were built up from the alluvium laid down by the Indus, the Ganga and the Brahmaputra and their tributaries.

Q.5 · Answer (B) Leaching

Laterite soil forms where high temperature and heavy rainfall go together: the rain leaches away lime and silica, leaving a soil rich in iron oxide and aluminium compounds. Heat alone does not make it.

Q.11 · Answer (D) Nagaland

Nagaland was the only state whose population fell between the 2001 and 2011 censuses: its decadal growth was –0.58%.

Q.12 · Answer (D) health

In March 2023 the Rajasthan Assembly passed the Rajasthan Right to Health Care Bill, making Rajasthan the first state to give its residents a legal right to health care.

Q.15 · Answer (D) West Bengal

In 2022 West Bengal had by far the largest share of India's jute mills, mostly along the Hooghly near Kolkata, close to the jute-growing areas of the Ganga-Brahmaputra delta.

Q.18 · Answer (D) 2 October 1869

Mohandas Karamchand Gandhi was born at Porbandar, in present-day Gujarat, on 2 October 1869.

Q.23 · Answer (C) Anthracene

Anthracene, a coal-tar hydrocarbon with three fused benzene rings, is a white to pale yellow crystalline solid that sublimes on heating, so it is purified by sublimation. Titanyl and orthovanadate are ions, and dysprosium is a rare-earth metal.

English Language and Comprehension

Q.1 · Answer (C) comeunication from the magistrate

'Comeunication' is misspelt: the word is 'communication'.

Q.2 · Answer (A) Widower

A 'widower' is a man whose wife has died; a 'widow' is a woman whose husband has died.

Q.3 · Answer (A) no sooner did he finish

'Did' takes the base form of the verb: 'No sooner did he finish his examination than he left'. ('No sooner had he finished' would also be correct, but 'had he finish' pairs 'had' with the base form.)

Q.4 · Answer (D) after the breakfast

The names of meals used in a general sense take no article: 'after breakfast'.

Q.5 · Answer (C) Legandry

'Legandry' is misspelt: the word is 'legendary'.

Q.6 · Answer (C) Cruel

'Humane' means kind and compassionate; its opposite is 'cruel'. 'Kind' is a synonym.

Q.7 · Answer (B) Prevention

The correct spelling is 'prevention'.

Q.8 · Answer (A) is better

'Than' needs the comparative: 'He is better at playing the guitar than his brother.'

Q.9 · Answer (A) diligent

'Idle' means lazy or not working; its opposite is 'diligent', hard-working.

Q.10 · Answer (C) speak
To 'speak' is to say something in order to convey information or express a feeling. To 'dictate' is to say words aloud for someone else to write down.

Q.11 · Answer (C) To end a quarrel and become friendly
To 'bury the hatchet' is to end a quarrel and make peace.

Q.12 · Answer (A) went to
In a question formed with 'did', the main verb takes its base form: 'Did her friend go to school yesterday?'

Q.13 · Answer (D) the threat to civic health
A danger is 'posed', and the noun that goes with 'pose' is 'threat': 'the threat to civic health posed by the polluted waters'. A warning only tells of a danger; 'peril' is close in meaning but does not pair with 'posed' as naturally.

Q.14 · Answer (C) hardly
The adverb of 'hard' is 'hard': 'he works hard'. 'Hardly' means scarcely, the opposite of what is meant.

Q.15 · Answer (A) Continuously
'Day and night' means all the time, continuously: 'They worked day and night to finish the bridge.'

Q.16 · Answer (C) Arrogance
'Humility' is a modest view of one's own importance; its opposite is 'arrogance'.

Q.17 · Answer (D) had arrived
'Had been dancing' already marks the earlier action, so the action that came after takes the simple past: 'when our dance teacher arrived'.

Q.18 · Answer (D) in a nutshell
'In a nutshell' means briefly, in a few words, which is what Jane asks for instead of long stories.

Q.19 · Answer (A) smart and clever
'(As) sly as a fox' describes someone cunning and crafty; of the options only 'smart and clever' fits.

Q.20 · Answer (A) identity
An 'identity card' shows who its holder is, which is what a security guard checks at the entrance.

Q.21 · Answer (A) behind
The emotion and intentions 'behind' the information are what lie under it and give rise to it.

Q.22 · Answer (C) listen
Besides conveying a message clearly, one must 'listen' so as to take in the full meaning of what is said and make the speaker feel heard.

Q.23 · Answer (D) important
The passage recommends learning these skills, so they are 'important' ones; 'boring', 'trivial' and 'wasteful' would undercut it.

Q.24 · Answer (D) deepen
The skills strengthen relationships, in line with 'build greater trust and respect': they 'deepen' your connections to others. 'Hamper' and 'disturb' say the opposite.

Q.25 · Answer (C) improve
The sentence lists benefits, so the skills 'improve' teamwork, problem solving and health; 'hasten' does not fit teamwork or health.

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